“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Madhya-līlā

Chapter 19

# The Mercy Shown to Śrī Rūpa

*(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the «Anubhāṣya», 2026 — draft)*

**1** Eager to restore the account of Vṛndāvana’s pastimes full of rasa, which had been lost over time, the Lord infused His own power into Rūpa and spread it anew, just as long ago He had infused His power into Brahmā and so brought forth the creation of the world.

**2** Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura![1]

**3** Śrī Rūpa and Sanātana were staying in the village of Rāmakeli. Having met the Lord there, they returned to their own homes.

**4** The two brothers devised a way to give up their worldly affairs: they engaged two brāhmaṇas and gave them much wealth.

**5** These brāhmaṇas performed two puraścaraṇas for them with the Kṛṣṇa mantra, so that the brothers might soon attain the feet of Caitanya.

**6** Then Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī loaded a boat and came to his own home, bringing great wealth with him.[2]

**7** He gave half of that wealth to brāhmaṇas and Vaiṣṇavas, and a quarter for the support of his relatives.

**8** The remaining quarter he saved against punishment and imprisonment, leaving it on deposit with trustworthy brāhmaṇas.[3]

**9** In Gauḍa he left ten thousand coins in the keeping of a grocer, for Sanātana to spend.

**10** Śrī Rūpa heard that the Lord had gone to Nīlādri and would go to Śrī Vṛndāvana by the forest path.

**11** Rūpa Gosvāmī sent two men to Nīlācala to learn when the Lord would set out for Vṛndāvana.

**12** “Come back quickly and bring me news of Him. When I hear it, I shall act accordingly.”

**13** Meanwhile Sanātana Gosvāmī thought to himself: “The king is fond of me, and that is my bondage.

**14** If somehow the king grows angry with me, I shall be released. That is my resolve.”

**15** Pretending to be ill, he stayed at home. He gave up the king’s business and no longer went to the court.

**16** Greedy kāyastha officials carried on the king’s business, while he himself studied the scriptures at home.[4]

**17** Gathering twenty or thirty learned bhaṭṭācāryas and paṇḍitas, he would sit in assembly with them and study the *Bhāgavata*.

**18** One day the ruler of Gauḍa, with one companion, suddenly came into the Gosvāmī's assembly.[5]

**19** Seeing the emperor, everyone rose in awe, and with due respect they offered the king a seat.

**20** The king said: "I sent my physician to you, and he says, 'There is no illness; I found him healthy.'

**21** Whatever business I have rests entirely on you, yet you have left your work and sit at home.

**22** You have ruined all my affairs and undertakings. What is in your heart? Tell me."

**23** Sanātana said: "The work can no longer be done by me. Have someone else see to it."

**24** Then the king grew angry and spoke again: "Your 'elder brother' behaves like a robber.[6]

**25** Killing living beings and animals, he has laid waste all the districts, and here you have ruined all my affairs."

**26** Sanātana said: "You are the independent ruler of Gauḍa. Whatever fault anyone commits, give him its fruit."[7]

**27** Hearing this, the ruler of Gauḍa rose and went back to his palace. Fearing that Sanātana would flee, he had him put in confinement.

**28** At that time the king set out to attack the Oriyās, and he said to Sanātana: "Come with me."

**29** He replied: “You are going to bring pain to the Deity. I have no strength to go with you.”

**30** Then the king departed, leaving him in confinement. Meanwhile the Lord set out from Nīlācala for Vṛndāvana.

**31** Then the two messengers came back to Rūpa and told him: “The Lord has set out for Vṛndāvana.”

**32** Hearing this, Śrī Rūpa wrote to Sanātana: “Śrī Caitanya Gosāñi has set out for Vṛndāvana.

**33** We two brothers are setting out to meet Him. Get free in whatever way you can and come away from there.

**34** Ten thousand coins are there with the grocer. Use them to free yourself quickly.

**35** Get free in whatever way you can and come to Vṛndāvana.” Having written this, the two brothers set out.

**36** Anupama Mallika, whose name was Śrī Vallabha, was Rūpa Gosvāmī’s younger brother and a great Vaiṣṇava.[8]

**37** Taking him along, Rūpa Gosvāmī came to Prayāga, and he rejoiced to hear that Mahāprabhu was there.

**38** The Lord had gone for darśana of Bindu-mādhava, and hundreds of thousands of people came to meet Him.

**39** Some wept, some laughed, some danced and sang, and some rolled on the ground, crying, “Kṛṣṇa! Kṛṣṇa!”

**40** The Gaṅgā and the Yamunā could not flood Prayāga, but the Lord flooded it with the deluge of love for Kṛṣṇa.

**41** Seeing the crowd, the two brothers stayed apart in a secluded place. At the sight of Mādhava the Lord was overwhelmed with ecstasy.

**42** Absorbed in love, the Lord danced, calling out the name of Hari. Raising His arms, He said: "Say 'Hari! Hari!'"

**43** Seeing the Lord's greatness, the people were amazed. I cannot describe the Lord's pastimes in Prayāga.

**44** The Lord was acquainted with a brāhmaṇa from the South, and that brāhmaṇa invited Him and took Him to his home.

**45** The Lord came to the brāhmaṇa's house and sat in seclusion, and there Śrī Rūpa and Vallabha both came to meet Him.

**46** Each holding a bunch of straw between his teeth, the two of them saw the Lord from afar and fell flat on the ground like rods.

**47** Reciting various verses, they rose and fell again and again. At the sight of the Lord both were overwhelmed with love.

**48** Seeing Śrī Rūpa, the Lord was pleased at heart. "Get up, get up, Rūpa! Come here!" He said.

**49** "Kṛṣṇa's mercy cannot be described at all. He has pulled you both out of the well of worldly life."

**50** "Even a knower of the four Vedas is not dear to Me if he is not devoted to Me, but My devotee is dear to Me even if he was born a dog-eater. One

should give to him and accept from him; he is to be worshipped just as I am." (Itihāsa-samuccaya, quoted in Hari-bhakti-vilāsa, 10.91)[9]

**51** Reciting this verse, He embraced them both, and in His mercy He placed His feet on their heads.

**52** Having received the Lord's mercy, the two of them joined their palms and, humble and meek, offered prayers:

**53** "Obeisances to You, the most munificent, the giver of love for Kṛṣṇa! Obeisances to Kṛṣṇa Himself, who bears the name Kṛṣṇa Caitanya and shines with a golden complexion."

**54** "I take refuge in Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, the doer of wondrous deeds, who in His mercy cured the world maddened by ignorance and then made it mad with the nectar of His own treasure of love." (Govinda-līlāmṛta, 1.2)

**55** Then Mahāprabhu seated him close by and asked him: "Tell Me the news of Sanātana."

**56** Rūpa said: "He is a prisoner in the king's house. If You deliver him, then he will be delivered."

**57** The Lord said: "Sanātana has already been released, and he will soon meet Me."

**58** The brāhmaṇa asked the Lord to take His midday meal, and Rūpa Gosvāmī stayed there that day.

**59** The Bhaṭṭācārya invited the two brothers as well, and they received the plate with the remnants of the Lord's prasāda.[10]

**60** The Lord was staying at Triveṇī, and the two brothers took lodging near Him.

**61** At that time Vallabha Bhaṭṭa was living in the village of Āḍāila. Hearing that Mahāprabhu had come, he came to Him.[11]

**62** He fell before the Lord in obeisance, and the Lord embraced him. Then the two of them spoke about Kṛṣṇa for some time.

**63** As they spoke of Kṛṣṇa, great love surged up in the Lord, but out of reserve before Bhaṭṭa He held it back.[12]

**64** Yet within, His love was seething and could not be restrained, and Vallabha Bhaṭṭa was amazed at heart to see it.

**65** Then Bhaṭṭa invited Mahāprabhu for a meal, and Mahāprabhu introduced the two brothers to him.

**66** From a distance the two brothers fell to the ground and, in great humility, offered obeisances to Bhaṭṭa.

**67** When Bhaṭṭa went to embrace them, they both drew far back: “I am untouchable and sinful. Do not touch me!”

**68** Bhaṭṭa was astonished, and the Lord was pleased at heart. Then the Lord told Bhaṭṭa about Rūpa:[13]

**69** “Do not touch him; he is of very low birth! And you are a Vedic scholar, a performer of sacrifices, learned and of noble family!”

**70** Hearing the name of Kṛṣṇa constantly from Rūpa’s mouth, and grasping something of the Lord’s hint, Bhaṭṭa said:

**71** “The name of Kṛṣṇa is dancing in the mouths of both. These two are not ‘lowly’ — they are ‘the best of all.’”

**72** “Oh, how wonderful! Even a dog-eater is worthy of the highest honour if Your name is on the tip of his tongue. Those who utter Your name have already performed austerities and offered sacrifices; they have bathed in all the holy waters, they are truly noble, and they have studied the Vedas.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 3.33.7)[14]

**73** Hearing this, Mahāprabhu praised him highly and, overwhelmed with love, began to recite verses:

**74** “One in whom the blazing fire of true devotion has burned away the taint of low birth is pure; even if born a dog-cooker, he is praised by the wise. But an unbeliever is not praised, even if he knows the Vedas.” (Hari-bhakti-sudhodaya, 3.11)[15]

**75** “For one devoid of devotion to the Lord, high birth, learning in scripture, japa and austerity are like ornaments on a lifeless body: they only please the people.” (Hari-bhakti-sudhodaya, 3.12)

**76** Seeing the Lord’s absorption in love, His power, which is the very essence of devotion, and His beauty and other qualities, Bhaṭṭa was amazed.

**77** Bhaṭṭa seated the Lord and His companions in a boat and set out with them for his own home to offer Him a meal.

**78** Seeing the glossy dark water of the Yamunā, Mahāprabhu was overwhelmed with love.

**79** With a loud roar He leaped into the water of the Yamunā. Seeing this, everyone trembled with fear.

**80** In great haste they all caught hold of the Lord and lifted Him out, and on the boat the Lord began to dance.

**81** Under Mahāprabhu's weight the boat rocked to and fro, and as water gushed in, it began to sink.

**82** Although in Bhaṭṭa's presence the Lord had steadied His mind, His irresistible, mighty love could not be held back.

**83** Considering the place and the people, Mahāprabhu became composed, and the boat came to land at the ghāṭa of Āḍāila.[16]

**84** Out of fear Bhaṭṭa stayed close by the Lord. After seeing to His midday bath, he took the Lord with him to his own house.

**85** Joyfully Bhaṭṭa offered Him a fine seat and himself washed the Lord's feet.

**86** With his whole family he placed that water on his head, and he dressed the Lord in a new kaupīna and outer cloth.

**87** He worshipped the Lord grandly with sandal paste, flowers, incense and lamps, and with due respect he had Balabhadra Bhaṭṭācārya do the cooking.[17]

**88** With affection and care he fed the Lord, and he also fed the two brothers, Rūpa Gosvāmī and Anupama.

**89** The Bhaṭṭācārya had the Lord's remnants given to Śrī Rūpa, and Kṛṣṇadāsa then received what remained of that prasāda.

**90** He gave the Lord spices to freshen His mouth and had Him lie down to rest, and Bhaṭṭa himself massaged the Lord's feet.

**91** The Lord sent him to take his meal, and after eating he came back to the Lord's feet.

**92** At that time Raghupati Upādhyāya arrived, a paṇḍita from Tirhut, a great Vaiṣṇava and a noble soul.[18]

**93** He came and bowed at the Lord's feet, and the Lord said to him: "May your mind rest in Kṛṣṇa."

**94** Hearing this, Upādhyāya was delighted at heart. The Lord said to him: "Describe Kṛṣṇa to Me."

**95** He recited a verse of his own about Kṛṣṇa's pastimes, and hearing it, Mahāprabhu was overwhelmed with great love.

**96** "Let those who fear worldly existence worship — some the śruti, others the smṛti, still others the Mahābhārata. But here I bow to Nanda, in whose courtyard the Supreme Brahman plays." (Padyāvalī, 126)

**97** When the Lord said, "Speak on," Upādhyāya continued, and Raghupati Upādhyāya bowed down before Him.[19]

**98** "To whom can I tell it, and who would believe it now, that in the groves of the daughter of the Sun, the Yamunā, Brahman is the lover of the young cowherd girls?" (Padyāvalī, 98)

**99** The Lord said, "Go on," and he recited verses on Kṛṣṇa's pastimes. In the ecstasy of love the Lord's body and mind were thrown into turmoil.

**100** Seeing such love, Upādhyāya was amazed. "He is not a human being," he concluded. "He is Kṛṣṇa."

**101** The Lord said: “Upādhyāya, whom do you consider the best?” “*Śyāmam eva paraṁ rūpam* — the dark form is the supreme form,” said Upādhyāya.

**102** “Which abode of that dark form do you consider the best?” “*Purī madhu-purī varā* — Madhupurī is the best of cities,” said Upādhyāya.

**103** “Of childhood, boyhood and youth, which do you consider the best?” “*Vayaḥ kaiśorakaṁ dhyeyam* — youth is the age to meditate on,” said Upādhyāya.

**104** “Among all the rasas, which do you consider the best?” “*Ādya eva paro rasaḥ* — the original rasa is the highest,” said Upādhyāya.[20]

**105** The Lord said: “You have taught Me an excellent truth.” Saying this, He recited the verse in a voice choked with emotion:

**106** “The dark form is the supreme form; Madhupurī is the best of cities; youth (kaiśora) is the age to meditate on; and the original rasa, śṛṅgāra, is the highest rasa.” (Padyāvalī, 82)[21]

**107** In His rapture the Lord embraced him, and Upādhyāya, intoxicated with love, began to dance.

**108** Seeing this, Vallabha Bhaṭṭa was amazed. He brought his two sons and had them fall at the Lord’s feet.[22]

**109** All the people of the village came to see the Lord, and on seeing Him they all became devotees of Kṛṣṇa.

**110** All the brāhmaṇas wanted to invite the Lord, but Vallabha Bhaṭṭa held them all back:

**111** “In the madness of love Gosāñi throws Himself into the middle of the Yamunā. I will take Him to Prayāga; I will not let Him stay here.

**112** Whoever wishes may go to Prayāga and invite Him there.” Saying this, he took the Lord and set out.

**113** Seating Mahāprabhu in a boat, Bhaṭṭa brought Gosāñi to Prayāga by way of the Gaṅgā.

**114** Fearing the crowds, the Lord went to Daśāśvamedha, and there He taught Rūpa Gosvāmī, infusing him with His power.

**115** The Lord taught him everything: the truth of Kṛṣṇa, the truth of devotion and the truth of rasa to its furthest limit — the conclusions of the *Bhāgavata*.

**116** All the conclusions He had heard from Rāmānanda He mercifully infused into Rūpa.

**117** The Lord infused His power into Śrī Rūpa’s heart and, revealing every truth to him, made him a master of them all.

**118** Kavi-karṇapūra, the son of Śivānanda Sena, has written at length in his book about the Lord’s meeting with Rūpa.

**119** “Since over time the account of the pastimes of Vṛndāvana had been lost, the Lord, to make it known in a special way, sprinkled Rūpa and Sanātana there with the nectar of His mercy.” (Caitanya-candrodaya, 9.38)

**120** “Though Śrī Rūpa had long been bound fast by the many qualities of his Beloved, he was free from attachment to home. The Lord is like the supreme rasa, which, though intangible, has taken on a visible form. In

Prayāga He favoured Rūpa and his younger brother Anupama with loving talks and the joy of the tightest embraces." (Caitanya-candrodaya, 9.29)[23]

**121** "Rūpa is dear to the Lord by his very nature and beloved by Him; he is love embodied, and his form is naturally beautiful. He is like the Lord Himself, His principal form and the form of His own pastimes. Through such a Rūpa the Lord spread the scriptures of bhakti-rasa." (Caitanya-candrodaya, 9.30)[24]

**122** In this way Karṇapūra writes in various places how the Lord showed His mercy to Rūpa and Sanātana.

**123** Every one of Mahāprabhu's great devotees held Rūpa and Sanātana in affection and esteem.

**124** Whenever anyone returned home after seeing Vṛndāvana, the Lord's associates would ask him:

**125** "Tell us, how are Rūpa and Sanātana faring there? How do they live, what is their renunciation like, what do they eat?

**126** How do they worship Śrī Kṛṣṇa all day and night?" Then those devotees would answer with praise:

**127** "They have no dwelling. They sleep under the trees of the forest, under each tree for one night only.

**128** In the homes of brāhmaṇas they take a full meal as alms; elsewhere they gather mādhukarī. Rejecting all enjoyment, they chew dry bread and parched chickpeas.[25]

**129** They carry nothing in their hands but a water pot; they have a patched quilt and a torn outer cloth. Talks of Kṛṣṇa, the name of Kṛṣṇa and jubilant dancing are their life.

**130** Throughout the eight *praharas* of day and night they worship Kṛṣṇa, sleeping only four *daṇḍas* — and on some days, in their love for the congregational chanting of the name, not even that.

**131** Sometimes they write scriptures on the rasa of devotion; they hear talks about Caitanya and meditate on Him."

**132** Hearing this, the great souls were overjoyed. What wonder is there in one on whom Caitanya's mercy rests?

**133** Rūpa himself has written of Caitanya's mercy in the auspicious invocation (*maṅgalācaraṇa*) of his book *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu*:

**134** "Though I am wretched, I have been set to this work by His prompting within my heart. I worship the lotus feet of that Hari, Śrī Caitanya-deva." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.1.2)

**135** In this way the Lord stayed at Prayāga for ten days and taught Śrī Rūpa, infusing him with His power.

**136** The Lord said: "Listen, Rūpa, to the characteristics of bhakti-rasa. I shall speak of it briefly, in the form of sūtras; it cannot be described in full.

**137** The ocean of bhakti-rasa is deep and has no shore on either side. To give you a taste of it, I shall tell you of a single drop.

**138** Countless jīvas fill the universe, wandering through the 8,400,000 species of life.

**139** Divide the tip of a hair into a hundred parts, and one of these again into a hundred: as subtle as that, I consider, is the jīva's own nature (*svarūpa*).

**140** "This jīva, subtle by nature, is like a hundredth part of a hundredth part of the tip of a hair. These particles of spirit are indeed beyond counting."[26]

**141** "The jīva should be known as a part of the tip of a hair divided into a hundred, and that hundredth divided again a hundredfold — so says the supreme *śruti*." (Śvetāśvatara Upaniṣad, 5.9)

**142** "Of subtle things, I am the jīva." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.16.11)

**143** (The personified Vedas pray:) "O Eternal One! If the countless, eternal embodied beings were all-pervading, there would be no law that they are subject to You; yet it cannot be otherwise. That from which they are born, never leaving them, is their controller. The doctrine of those who regard them as equal to You is unacceptable, for it is flawed at its root." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.87.30)

**144** Among them there are two divisions — the stationary and the moving; and the moving are divided into birds, water-dwellers and land-dwellers.

**145** Among these, human beings are very few; and among humans there are *mlecchas*, Pulindas, Buddhists and Śabaras.

**146** Of those faithful to the Vedas, half accept the Vedas only with their lips: they commit sins the Vedas forbid and have no regard for *dharma*.

**147** Among those who practise *dharma*, many are devoted to *karma*; among millions devoted to *karma*, one *jñānī* is best.

**148** Among millions of *jñānīs*, one is liberated (*mukta*); and among millions of the liberated, even one devotee of Kṛṣṇa is rare.

**149** A devotee of Kṛṣṇa is free from desire, and therefore peaceful (*śānta*). Those who desire enjoyment, liberation or mystic perfections are all restless.

**150** “O great sage, even among millions of the liberated and the perfected, one devoted to Nārāyaṇa, whose mind is at peace, is very rare.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 6.14.5)

**151** Wandering through the universe, some fortunate jīva, by the mercy of guru and Kṛṣṇa, obtains the seed of the creeper of devotion (*bhakti-latā*).[27]

**152** Becoming a gardener, he plants that seed and waters it with hearing and chanting.

**153** Sprouting, the creeper grows and pierces through the universe; passing beyond the Virajā and Brahmaloka, it reaches the spiritual sky (*paravyoma*).

**154** Then it goes higher still, to Goloka Vṛndāvana, and climbs the wish-fulfilling tree of Kṛṣṇa’s feet.

**155** There it spreads and bears the fruit of prema, while here the gardener daily sprinkles it with the water of hearing, chanting and the rest.

**156** If an offence against a Vaiṣṇava rises up like a mad elephant, it uproots or breaks the creeper, and its leaves wither away.

**157** Therefore the gardener carefully fences the creeper round, so that the elephant of offence may not rise up.

**158** But side shoots (*upaśākhā*) may rise up together with the creeper — the desire for enjoyment and liberation; there is no counting them.

**159** Forbidden conduct, duplicity, violence to living beings, gain, honour, prestige and the rest — these are all side shoots.

**160** Receiving the water that is sprinkled, the side shoots grow, while the main branch is stunted and cannot grow.

**161** First of all the gardener cuts away the side shoots; then the main branch grows and reaches Vṛndāvana.

**162** The fruit of prema ripens and falls, and the gardener tastes it. Holding to the creeper, he reaches the wish-fulfilling tree.

**163** There he serves that wish-fulfilling tree and happily tastes the juice (rasa) of the fruit of prema.

**164** This is the supreme fruit, the supreme goal of life (*parama-puruṣārtha*), before which the four goals of life are like straw.

**165** "Rich mastery over the host of mystic perfections, *samādhi* grounded in truth and *dharma*, even the great bliss of Brahman — these astonish one only so long as not even the fragrance of prema, the sovereign herb that brings Kṛṣṇa, the foe of Madhu, under control, has set out on the road of the heart." (Lalita-mādhava, 5.2)[28]

**166** From pure devotion (*śuddha-bhakti*) prema is born; therefore I shall tell you the characteristics of pure devotion.

**167** "Devotion of the highest kind is the favourable cultivation of service to Kṛṣṇa, free from all other desires and unobscured by *jñāna*, *karma* and the like." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.1.11)

**168** Giving up other desires, the worship of others, *jñāna* and *karma*, one cultivates service to Kṛṣṇa with all the senses in a favourable spirit.

**169** This is pure devotion, and from it prema arises. The Pañcarātra and the *Bhāgavata* describe these characteristics.

**170** “Service to the master of the senses (*Hṛṣīkeśa*) with one’s senses, free from all designations and made pure by dedication to Him alone, is called devotion.” (Nārada-pañcarātra, quoted in Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.1.12)

**171–172** “Merely by hearing of My qualities the mind flows unbroken toward Me, who dwell in all hearts, as the waters of the Gaṅgā flow into the ocean. Such is the mark of bhakti-yoga beyond the guṇas (*nirguṇa*): devotion to the Supreme Person that is unmotivated and uninterrupted.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 3.29.11–12)[29]

**173** “My devotees accept nothing but service to Me — not even when they are offered residence in My world, opulence equal to Mine, a form like Mine, nearness to Me, or even oneness with Me.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 3.29.13)[30]

**174** “That alone, called bhakti-yoga, is declared the ultimate goal; by it one transcends the three guṇas and attains love for Me.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 3.29.14)

**175** If the desire for enjoyment, liberation and the like remains in the mind, then even though one practises *sādhana*, prema does not arise.[31]

**176** “As long as the witch of craving for enjoyment and liberation remains in the heart, how can the happiness of devotion arise there?” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.2.22)

**177** From the practice of devotion (*sādhana-bhakti*) rati awakens; when rati deepens, it is called prema.

**178** As prema increases, its stages are called *sneha*, *māna*, *praṇaya*, *rāga*, *anurāga*, *bhāva* and *mahābhāva*.

**179** It is like the seed, the sugarcane, its juice, molasses, raw sugar, refined sugar, white sugar, sugar candy, rock candy and the finest rock candy.

**180** All these are the *sthāyi-bhāva*, the abiding emotion, of the rasa of devotion to Kṛṣṇa. When *vibhāva* and *anubhāva* combine with the *sthāyi-bhāva*,[32]

**181** together with the *sāttvika* and *vyabhicārī-bhāvas*, then by their union the rasa of devotion to Kṛṣṇa becomes nectar to taste.

**182** It is like yogurt, sugar candy, ghee, black pepper and camphor: mixed together, they become *rasālā*, sweet as nectar.

**183–184** According to the difference in devotees, rati is of five kinds — *śānta-rati*, *dāsya-rati*, *sakhya-rati*, *vātsalya-rati* and *madhura-rati*. And according to the difference in rati, the rasa of devotion to Kṛṣṇa is of five kinds.

**185** Their names are *śānta*, *dāsya*, *sakhya*, *vātsalya* and *madhura-rasa*; these five are the principal rasas of devotion to Kṛṣṇa.

**186** “Laughter, wonder, heroism, compassion, anger, fear and disgust: thus the secondary rasa is sevenfold.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.5.116)

**187** *Hāsya*, *adbhuta*, *vīra*, *karuṇa*, *raudra*, *bībhatsa* and *bhaya* — these seven secondary rasas arise in the five kinds of devotees.

**188** The five rasas are permanent (*sthāyī*) and pervade the devotee’s mind; the seven secondary ones are incidental (*āgantuka*), arising from some cause.

**189** The devotees in *śānta* are the nine Yogendras, and also Sanaka and the others; the devotees in the mood of servitude are countless servants everywhere.

**190** The devotees in *sakhya* are Śrīdāmā and the others, and in the city, Bhīma and Arjuna; the devotees in *vātsalya* are His mother and father and all His elders.

**191** In *madhura-rasa* the foremost devotees are the gopīs of Vraja; then come the queens and the Lakṣmīs, countless in number.

**192** Again, rati for Kṛṣṇa is of two kinds: mixed with awareness of His majesty (*aiśvarya*), and pure (*kevalā*).

**193** In Gokula rati is pure, devoid of awareness of majesty; in the two cities and in Vaikuṇṭha and the other abodes, majesty predominates.

**194** Where awareness of majesty predominates, love is constricted. Not to heed majesty even when one sees it — that is the way of pure love.

**195** In *śānta* and *dāsya-rasa* majesty is at times a stimulus (*uddīpana*) to love; in *sakhya*, *vātsalya* and *madhura-rasa* it constricts love.

**196** When Kṛṣṇa bowed at the feet of Vasudeva and Devakī, fear arose in both their minds, for they were aware of His majesty.

**197** “Knowing their two sons to be the Lords of the universe, Devakī and Vasudeva were filled with apprehension and did not embrace Them, though They had bowed to them.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.44.51)

**198** Seeing Kṛṣṇa’s universal form, Arjuna was afraid, and humbly begged pardon for the boldness he had shown in his friendship.

**199–200** “Whatever I said rashly, thinking of You as my friend — ‘O Kṛṣṇa! O Yādava! O friend!’ — unaware of this greatness of Yours, out of carelessness or out of love; and whatever disrespect I showed You in jest, at play, in bed, in sitting or at meals, alone or in the presence of others, O Acyuta — for all that I beg forgiveness of You, the immeasurable.” (Bhagavad-gītā, 11.41–42)

**201** When Kṛṣṇa jested with Rukmiṇī, she was terrified, thinking that Kṛṣṇa would leave her.

**202** “Overwhelmed by grief, fear and sorrow, she lost her wits: the fan fell from her hand as her bracelets slipped, and, her mind failing, she suddenly fell senseless, her hair scattered, like a plantain tree blown down by the wind.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.60.24)

**203** Pure love of the *kevalā* kind does not know majesty; even when it sees majesty, it heeds only its own relationship with Kṛṣṇa.

**204** “She looked upon Hari, whose glory is sung by the three Vedas, the Upaniṣads, the works on Sāṅkhya and yoga and the Sātvata scriptures, as her own son.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.8.45)[33]

**205** “Thinking the unmanifest Lord, who is beyond the senses and had appeared in human form, to be her own son, the gopī tied Him to the mortar with a rope, as if He were an ordinary child.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.9.14)

**206** “Defeated, the Lord Kṛṣṇa carried Śrīdāmā; Bhadrasena carried Vṛṣabha, and Pralamba carried the son of Rohiṇī.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.18.24)

**207** “And She then thought Herself the best of all women: ‘My Beloved has left the other gopīs, who long for Him, and serves Me.’” (Śrīmad-

Bhāgavatam, 10.30.37)[34]

**208** “Then, coming to a part of the forest, She said proudly to Keśava: ‘I cannot walk any further. Carry Me wherever You wish.’” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.30.38)

**209** “So addressed, He said to His beloved, ‘Climb onto My shoulder.’ But then Kṛṣṇa vanished, and the young gopī was filled with remorse.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.30.39)

**210** “Disregarding husbands, sons, kin, brothers and relatives, we have come to Your side, O Acyuta, enchanted by Your song. You know why we have come. O cheat, who would abandon women at night?” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.31.16)

**211** In *śānta-rasa*, through awareness of one’s own true nature (*svarūpa*), one is fixed on Kṛṣṇa alone. ‘*Śama* is the fixing of the intellect on Me’ — so the Lord has said with His own lips.[35]

**212** “‘*Śama* is the fixing of the intellect on Me’ — so says Śrī Bhagavān. Without this *śānta-rati*, such fixing of the intellect on Him is hard to achieve.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.5.21)[36]

**213** “*Śama* is the fixing of the intellect on Me; *dama*, restraint of the senses; *titikṣā*, patient endurance of suffering; *dhṛti*, conquest of the tongue and the genitals.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.19.36)

**214** Giving up thirst for everything but Kṛṣṇa — that, I consider, is its function. Therefore I know only the devotee of Kṛṣṇa to be truly peaceful (*śānta*).

**215** A devotee of Kṛṣṇa regards heaven and liberation as hell. Fixedness on Kṛṣṇa and the giving up of thirst — these are the two qualities of *śānta*.

**216** “Those who are devoted to Nārāyaṇa fear nothing from any quarter; in heaven, in liberation and even in hell they see the same worth.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 6.17.28)[37]

**217** These two qualities pervade all devotees, just as sound, the quality of ether, pervades all the elements.

**218** The nature of *śānta* is to be devoid of even a trace of the sense that Kṛṣṇa is ‘my own’ (*mamatā*); in it knowledge of Him as the Supreme Brahman and the Supersoul (*Paramātmā*) predominates.[38]

**219** In *śānta-rasa* there is only knowledge of His true nature (*svarūpa*); in *dāsya* there is more — knowledge of Him as the Master full of all majesty.

**220** In it there is awareness of Him as the Lord, with abundant awe and reverence; and by their service the devotees constantly give Kṛṣṇa happiness.

**221** The quality of *śānta* is present in *dāsya*, and service besides; therefore *dāsya-rasa* has these two qualities.

**222** The quality of *śānta* and the service of *dāsya* — both are present in *sakhya*. But whereas the service of *dāsya* is full of awe and reverence, in *sakhya* it is full of trust.

**223** They climb on His shoulders and carry Him on theirs, and play at fighting with Him. They serve Kṛṣṇa, and they make Kṛṣṇa serve them.

**224** *Sakhya* is founded chiefly on intimate trust (*viśrambha*) and is free of reverence and awe; therefore *sakhya-rasa* is marked by three qualities.

**225** In it the sense of Kṛṣṇa as ‘my own’ is greater, and one regards Kṛṣṇa as one’s equal; therefore the Lord is subdued by *sakhya-rasa*.

**226** In *vātsalya* there are the quality of *śānta* and the service of *dāsya*; but here that service is called nurturing (*pālana*).

**227** The quality of *sakhya* is there too — freedom from restraint, with no reverence at its core; and from an excess of the sense of Kṛṣṇa as ‘my own’, they chastise and scold Him.

**228** They regard themselves as His protectors and Kṛṣṇa as their dependent. With these four qualities, *vātsalya-rasa* is like nectar.

**229** Kṛṣṇa Himself is immersed with His devotee in that nectar of bliss. Those who know His majesty speak of this quality: ‘Kṛṣṇa is controlled by His devotees.’

**230** “By such pastimes He immerses His own cowherd village in a pool of bliss, and to those absorbed in knowledge of His lordship He proclaims that He is conquered by His devotees. Again, with love, I bow to Him a hundred times.” (Dāmodarāṣṭaka, 3)

**231** In *madhura-rasa* there are fixedness on Kṛṣṇa and abundant service, the unreserved freedom of *sakhya*, and, in still greater measure, the sense of ‘my own’ that belongs to nurturing.

**232** In the mood of His beloveds they serve Him with their own bodies; therefore *madhura-rasa* has five qualities.

**233** It is like the qualities of ether and the other elements, which increase in each succeeding element — one, two, three, four — until all five are found in earth.

**234** In the same way, all the moods are gathered together in *madhura*; therefore it astonishes by the abundance of its taste.

**235** I have given you only an overview of bhakti-rasa; meditate in your mind on its full elaboration.

**236** As one meditates on it again and again, Kṛṣṇa manifests within the heart, and by Kṛṣṇa's mercy even one who knows nothing reaches the far shore of the ocean of rasa."

**237** Saying this, the Lord embraced him, and then He made up His mind to go to Vārāṇasī.

**238** When the Lord rose in the morning and set out, Rūpa humbly made this request at His feet:

**239** "If You permit, I shall go with You. I cannot bear the waves of separation."

**240** The Lord said: "Your duty is to follow My word. You have come close to Vṛndāvana; go there.

**241** Then from Vṛndāvana, by way of Gauḍa-deśa, you will come to Nīlācala and meet Me there."

**242** Embracing him, the Lord boarded the boat, and Rūpa fell unconscious on the spot.

**243** The brāhmaṇa from the South took him to his home, and then the two brothers set out for Vṛndāvana.

**244** Mahāprabhu travelled on and on and came to Vārāṇasī, where Candraśekhara came out of the town and met Him.

**245** At night he had dreamt that the Lord had come to his house; so in the morning he came out and waited outside the town.

**246** Seeing the Lord so unexpectedly, he fell at His feet, and full of joy he took Him to his own house.

**247** Hearing of this, Tapana Miśra came and met the Lord. After talking with Him, he invited the Lord to take His meal.

**248** He took the Lord to his own house and fed Him, and Candraśekhara invited the Bhaṭṭācārya.[39]

**249** After feeding Him, Miśra clasped the Lord's feet and said: "I beg You for one favour; be merciful and grant it:

**250** as long as You stay in Kāśī, take Your meals nowhere but in my house."

**251** The Lord knew that He would stay only five or seven days, and that He would not take meals with the *sannyāsīs* anywhere.[40]

**252** Knowing this, He accepted Miśra's request to take His meals with him, and made Candraśekhara's house His residence.

**253** A brāhmaṇa from Mahārāṣṭra came and met Him, and the Lord, out of affection, showed him His mercy.

**254** Hearing that Mahāprabhu had come, many respectable people — brāhmaṇas and kṣatriyas — came to see Him.

**255** All the mercy the Lord showed Śrī Rūpa is a vast story; I have told it in brief.

**256** Whoever hears this account with faith obtains loving devotion at the feet of Caitanya.

**257** Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

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## Notes

1. The same verse as Ādi 4.2; translation as there. ↩
2. Edition heading: “Śrī Rūpa comes to his own home in Fateyābād.” ↩
3. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: he kept this money to ward off coming misfortune — the king’s punishment, imprisonment and the like. ↩
4. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the kāyasthas were officials who served under Sanātana. Seeing that he was inclined to renunciation, some of them, hoping to gain his post, began to show special zeal in the king’s affairs. Tradition says that after Sanātana his post went to his subordinate, Purandara Khān. ↩
5. *Anubhāṣya*: the ruler of Gauḍa was ʿAlāʾuddīn Sayyid Husain Shāh, who held the throne of Gauḍa from 1420 to 1443 of the Śaka era; it was he who came to Śrī Sanātana’s assembly. ↩
6. According to the *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*, the “elder brother” (in quotation marks in the edition) is the emperor himself: Husain Shāh regarded Sanātana as his “younger brother,” and in loving anger he says of himself that he only marches against other lands and, being a *yavana* by birth, hunts and kills many living beings and animals in the districts of Gauḍa. ↩
7. According to the *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*, these words carry a hidden meaning: the king, who himself behaves like a robber, will reap the fruit of that, and the minister who has neglected his duties deserves the fruit of dismissal. ↩
8. *Anubhāṣya*: on him see Ādi 10.84. ↩
9. Reference as in the edition’s heading: *Hari-bhakti-vilāsa* 10.91, words of the *Itihāsa-samuccaya*. ↩
10. The Bhaṭṭācārya here is evidently Balabhadra Bhaṭṭācārya, the Lord’s companion on the way to Vṛndāvana, who is so named in verse 87 (edition heading: “Balabhadra cooks the meal”); the host is the brāhmaṇa from the South (44). ↩
11. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Vallabha Bhaṭṭa was a Vaiṣṇava paṇḍita who later became an ācārya of the Viṣṇusvāmī sampradāya; he is known as

Vallabhācārya. Āḍāila is the village of Aḍeli on the far bank of the Yamunā, about a mile from the confluence. ↩

12. In this passage *bhaṭṭa* is Vallabha Bhaṭṭa; the *Bhaṭṭācārya* of verses 87 and 89 is Balabhadra Bhaṭṭācārya, the Lord's companion (*Anubhāṣya* on verse 87). ↩
13. Edition heading: "Seeing Vallabha, proud of his noble family and learning, as an outsider, the Lord gives him worldly honour — that is, He misleads him." ↩
14. The same verse as Madhya 11.192; translation as there. ↩
15. *Anubhāṣya*: the unbeliever (*nāstika*) is one who has turned away from the service of Kṛṣṇa; such a brāhmaṇa, even if he has mastered the Vedas, is to be avoided by one who seeks the highest goal. ↩
16. *Anubhāṣya*: "the place and the people" (*deśa-pātra*) — on a boat that was nearly sinking there was no room for dancing; moreover, beside a paṇḍita poor in prema such as Vallabha Dīkṣita, the sāttvika-bhāvas do not blossom. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: that place was almost devoid of prema, and beside Him was Vallabha Bhaṭṭa, much given to argument; seeing this, Mahāprabhu restrained Himself. ↩
17. The name of Balabhadra follows the edition's heading: "Worship of the Lord; Balabhadra cooks the meal." ↩
18. *Anubhāṣya*: *tiruhitā* means a native of Tirhut (today the districts of Saran, Champaran, Muzaffarpur and Darbhanga). *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Tirhut is the land of Mithilā; several verses by Raghupati Upādhyāya are included in the *Padyāvalī*. ↩
19. The lines of this verse follow the order of the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition (p. 669): first "*'āge kaha' — prabhu-vākye upādhyāya kahila*," then "*raghupati upādhyāya namaskāra kaila*." Other editions print them in the reverse order. ↩
20. Edition heading: "The transcendental *śṛṅgāra-rasa* is the highest of the rasas and the best object of worship." ↩
21. Edition heading: a verse of Mādhavendra Purī quoted in the *Padyāvalī* (82). ↩
22. *Anubhāṣya*: Vallabha's two sons were Gopīnātha and Viṭṭhaleśvara; but the Lord came to Prayāga in 1434 or 1435 of the Śaka era, when Viṭṭhala had not yet been born. In the edition "two" (*dui*) is followed by an editorial "(?)", and the heading speaks of one son. ↩
23. *Anubhāṣya*: the Beloved is Gaura; Śrī Rūpa's attachment to home was only enacted for the sake of the pastime. ↩
24. Edition heading: "*Śrī Caitanya-candrodaya-nāṭaka*, Act 9, words of Sārvabhauma" (the verse number is not given). ↩

25. *Anubhāṣya*: *sthūla-bhikṣā* is alms after which one need beg for no more food; *mādhukarī* — as the bee gathers honey from many flowers, so the renunciant collects a little food in many places. Renouncing everything that excites the senses, they sustained the body for bhajana on dry bread and parched chickpeas. ↩
26. Edition heading: a verse quoted in the commentary on the *Śruti-stava* (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.87). ↩
27. *Anubhāṣya*: the fortunate soul is one who has *sukṛti* that turns it toward devotion. The guru who gives the seed of the creeper of devotion is a manifestation of Bhagavān sent by Kṛṣṇa: by the guru's mercy one obtains Kṛṣṇa's mercy, and by Kṛṣṇa's mercy the guru's. ↩
28. *Anubhāṣya*: *satya-dharmā samādhiḥ* is concentration of mind founded on the *dharma* of truthfulness, purity, charity and austerity; *prema* here is love in *śānta* and the other *rasas*. Once the happiness of service to Kṛṣṇa is attained, the happiness of sense enjoyment, of *kaivalya* and of Brahman becomes insignificant. ↩
29. The same verses as Ādi 4.205–206; translation as there. ↩
30. The same verse as Ādi 4.207 (= Madhya 6.270, 9.268); translation as there, but in the order of this edition, which reads *sārūpya-sāmīpya* — first likeness of form, then nearness. ↩
31. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads *karile* ("performing"; elsewhere *karileo*, "even performing"); the sense is the same. ↩
32. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the *sthāyi-bhāva* is the "root" of *rasa*, *vibhāva* its "cause", and *anubhāva* and the *sāttvika-bhāvas* its "effects". ↩
33. *Anubhāṣya*: the three Vedas sing of Him as Indra and the other gods, the Upaniṣads as Brahman, Sāṅkhya as the Puruṣa, yoga as the Paramātmā, and the Pañcarātras and Āgamas as Bhagavān. ↩
34. References in 207–209 as in the edition's heading: Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.30.37–39 (elsewhere numbered 10.30.36–38). ↩
35. *Anubhāṣya*: when the idea of material enjoyment is dispelled, the *jīva* awakens to its own true nature, and that eternal nature is exclusive devotion to Kṛṣṇa. ↩
36. Reference as in the edition's heading: *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu*, Dakṣiṇa-vibhāga, "Śānta-bhakti-rasa-laharī", verse 21 (the verse stands in the fifth wave of the Dakṣiṇa-vibhāga, among the descriptions of *śānta-rati*). ↩
37. The same verse as Madhya 9.270; translation as there. ↩
38. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: in *śānta-rasa* there is no *mamatā*, and so the object of worship in it is "Parabrahman", "Paramātmā". The devotees in

*śānta* (Sanaka and the others, 189) love Kṛṣṇa Himself, but without the sense that He is “my own”. ↩

39. Edition heading: “Tapana Miśra invites the Lord, and Candraśekhara invites Balabhadra.” ↩
40. Edition heading: “Indicating that association with Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs* is bad association, the Lord grants His devotee’s request.” ↩